

function; however, the hour value should normally be between 0 and 23. If the value exceeds 23, then the number is divided by 24 and the remainder is taken as the hour value (see figure). Likewise, for the minute and second arguments the expected values should be between 0 and 59; if the values exceeds 59, it is converted into hours and minutes and added, in the case of the minute argument, to the minutes. Example: If the hour value is 1 and the minute value is 74 the hh:mm value will be 2:14, that is 74 minutes has been converted to 1 hour 14 minutes and added to the total. Similarly, for the second argument, if the values exceed 59, then it is converted into hours, minutes, and seconds and then added. See the figure to understand how this works.

TIMEVALUE(time_text)

Example: =TIMEVALUE(A1) where A1='8:15:46 PM

Similar to DATEVALUE, if the time is entered as a text in Excel by using the apostrophe before the time, then this function will convert it into the time format.

HOUR(serial_number)

Example: =HOUR(A1) where A1=9:30:24 PM

Extracts only the hour portion in the time value specified. In the above example, Excel will return the value 21, which is the value for 9 PM in the 24-hour format. Similarly, the functions MINUTE(serial_number) and SECOND(serial_number) extract the minutes and seconds in a specified time value respectively.

9.4 Financial Functions

Due to the use of financial terminology financial functions may seem the most obscure difficult to understand of all the functions available in Excel. We take you through the basics in this section. While some understanding of financial terms is always helpful you don't need to be accounting whiz kid to use the basic financial functions. We show you how.

PV(rate,nper,pmt,[fv],[type])